

Apple Releases Updated Printer Drivers

If your Epson and Lexmark printers aren't working on your Mac, turn on software updates to apply the latest drivers from Apple.

Trains running at 300mph

Japanese Maglev trains will now be running at 313 mph after approval of a new route

Photo Printer Test

stand why Epson has taken this approach – to urge users to buy legitimate ink, it is still a waste of time compared to the easy plug-n-play cartridge approach of the HP printers.

Once fired up, it's evident the Epson L100's more noisy than the two HP printers, definitely. We also bemoan the gargantuan amount of time the printer took to churn out prints, compared to the HP printers – 10 minutes 24 seconds for a test print against the HP e609a's 2 minutes 21 seconds. However, it must be said that the L100 consistently gave high-quality image prints throughout our casual and test benchmarks. Color quality was very good – a touch too oversaturated, gradients, shadows, reflection, the printer tackled every scenario admirably well. For future redesigns of the L100, we think if Epson can bring down the time taken to print copies significantly, it will find takers for this printer with its unique ink deployment system.

Epson Stylus Photo T60

Part of Epson's Stylus Photo series, the Epson T60 is the largest photo printer in this comparison. It's a big black chunk of glossy plastic, the T60, and fittingly the biggest, bulkiest printer in the comparison. Keeping it on an office desk cramped for space isn't easy, for it's both wider and taller than the other Epson, Canon, and HP printers in the fray. Actually, it's a bit of a disappointment when you learn this is only a single-function printer, given its bulk. While setting it up and connecting it to the wall socket, we realized the printer's power point is hard to access from the front. This is because the

power adapter (hidden inside the printer) has a port that is concealed along an edge on the back, and it's difficult to play with compared to the other printers.

On the plus side, the Epson Stylus Photo T60's front has three buttons – Power on, Ink level indicator, and cancel print jobs. The ink level indicator blinks red whenever a cartridge is low – this is good, no separate program installation is required – unlike the HP printers. The T60 uses six cartridges to churn out photo prints – Cyan, Magenta, Yellow, Black, Light Cyan and Light Magenta. Swapping cartridges isn't difficult at all.

We also realised, since we tried evaluating each printer vendor's support section on their respective product websites, that the Epson T60's drivers for Windows 7 64-bit edition were not present on Epson's India web site – we had to download the relevant drivers from Epson's Singapore web site. We hope Epson India looks into the matter and fixes their support software issues.

When we got down to testing the Epson T60, we realised the printer vibrates while printing. In fact the vibration is so unnatural that it's hard to miss – the other printers also vibrated with varying degree, but nothing so appreciable as the T60's amplitude. The printer vibrates the most in Draft mode, and a little less in mixed and photo mode.

The T60 deploys a back-loading tray for paper inlet,

PORTABLE PHOTO PRINTERS

EPSON PICTUREMATE PM235



Epson PictureMate PM235

Price ₹9,999

If you are a travelling photographer or someone who needs to carry a printer on their photo expeditions, only a portable photo printer will make sense for your needs. These printers are small and portable, easy-to-carry, but at the same time, they're sophisticated printing machines. The Epson PictureMate PM235 is one such portable printing solution.

The PictureMate PM235 is so in tune with its user's needs that it supports PC-less printing – you can insert your camera's memory card in the PM235's slots. It comes with its own battery pack. The tiny, cute-looking PM235 also has a 2.5-inch LCD screen for PC-less printing – you can decide what type of print you want, what paper, how many prints, etc., right through this screen and its accompanying command buttons, which are very easy to use.

The printer has a single slot-loading printer cartridge that gives very good 6-inch by 4-inch photo prints. The entire unit is very well built, there's a handle to hold the printer comfortably. It has collapsible front output tray, whereas 6-inch by 4-inch papers are fed through the top.

with prints coming out and dropping in the front tray. In fact, the printer's front output tray appears to be small at first – like the HP Deskjet Ink Advantage K109a and Officejet 6000 e609a – but has extendable plastic fins that are curved upwards. This keeps the printed output paper in stack and prevents it from spilling over. The tray

build quality is good and doesn't feel flimsy.

In terms of photo printing performance, the T60 was both good and bad. It was good in terms of overall print quality – warm colours, crisp outlines, good gradient levels, etc. But there were a few hiccups – shadows and reflections weren't reproduced as well as



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